



First Day on the Job

Job Readiness • complete 30-minute practice session

FOR STAFF • 30-MINUTE SESSION

Purpose: Practice what to do before leaving home, when arriving, and during the first few minutes of work.

Materials: This packet, pencil, optional backpack/lunchbox for role-play.

Easy flow: 5 min: talk through first-day nerves • 10 min: checklist • 10 min: role-play cards • 5 min: reflection.

1 • Before You Leave Home

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Check your start time | ☐ Plan your ride and leave early |
| ☐ Wear the correct clothes/uniform | ☐ Charge your phone, then silence it for work |
| ☐ Bring ID/forms if requested | ☐ Pack lunch/water if needed |
| ☐ Know the manager's name | ☐ Know where to enter the building |

Quick Decision

Your shift starts at 4:00 PM. The drive usually takes 18 minutes. You have to park, walk inside, and find your supervisor. Circle the BEST time to leave:

3:15 PM 3:30 PM 3:42 PM 3:55 PM

Why? _____

Why? _____

2 • The First 10 Minutes

1. Walk in calmly and put your phone away.
2. Tell the first employee you are new and ask where to meet your supervisor.
3. Greet your supervisor: “Hi, I’m _____. Today is my first day.”
4. Ask where to put your belongings.
5. Ask how to clock in.
6. Listen to instructions and ask questions if you are unsure.
7. Write down anything important.

What Would You Say?

SCENARIO: You cannot find the time clock.

I would say/do: _____

SCENARIO: Your supervisor is helping a customer.

I would say/do: _____

SCENARIO: You were told to wear black pants, but you wore jeans.

I would say/do: _____

SCENARIO: You realize you forgot your lunch.

I would say/do: _____

3 • Role-Play Cards • Cut Apart

NO SUPERVISOR IN SIGHT

You arrive 10 minutes early. Your supervisor is not at the front. Show how you would ask another employee for help.

I'M GOING TO BE LATE

Traffic is stopped. You may be 7 minutes late. Practice calling the workplace.

FIRST INTRODUCTION

Meet your supervisor for the first time. Introduce yourself and ask what you should do first.

I DON'T UNDERSTAND

Your supervisor explains a task quickly. You are confused. Practice asking for the directions again.

WHERE DO I PUT THIS?

You brought a backpack and lunch. Practice asking where personal items belong.

PHONE PROBLEM

A friend keeps texting during orientation. Explain what you should do with your phone.

Wrap-Up • Get Them Talking

💬 What part of a first day would make you most nervous?

💬 What could you do the night before to make the morning easier?

💬 What is one question you should NEVER be embarrassed to ask at a new job?
